Greater diplomatic attention, better functioning regional cooperation, increased economic, and humanitarian assistance, and improved regional connectivity are a bare minimum for India if it seeks to retain a leadership role in its neighbourhood. Even as India rises and its global ambitions increase, its immediate neighbours will remain a major priority—just as they were for other rising major powers. By contrast, neglecting the region could have important repercussions for Indian national security, which has long benefited from buffers to the north, manageable differences in the east, and an advantageous position in the Indian Ocean littoral. The growing influence and resources available to external actors, specifically China, have only increased Indian concerns, and forced it to improve upon its commitments and delivery. Given the structural factors at play, New Delhi must be prepared for cyclical ups and down in its neighbourhood relations, as political leaderships change due to factors outside of India's control. Mitigating differences while seizing positive signs of cooperation will gradually give the neighbourhood a stake in India's development—and vice versa. Ultimately, the future well-being of India's neighbourhood should matter far more to New Delhi than it does to any other major power.